

ESA Intranet

ESA News template *(previous design)*

Economic Services Administration		Britton, Chris   	
Title	Help with the Tiny Home Supply Drive		
Body	Economic Services Administration: You're invited to help welcome people into their new tiny homes <i>Showcase of Skills builds 25 homes; highlights needs for housing, career/technical education</i> On March 27, Olympia's Capitol Campus will become a construction zone when 25 teams from high schools, skills centers and community and technical colleges throughout Washington state converge to build 25 small houses in a Career and Technical Education Showcase of Skills. We know that having shelter can make a huge difference in a person's pathway to self-sufficiency. The houses will be received by Seattle's Low Income Housing Institute (LIHI) at a site in north Seattle called Nesbitt Center, a Seattle city-sanctioned tiny house village and part of Nickelsville, which serves homeless families and individuals. Everyone at ESA can play an integral part in helping this project and, in turn, helping end homelessness in Washington state. I challenge all of us at ESA (LINK TO VIDEO) to provide each of the houses with a Welcome Basket – an effort that began during the 2016 Combined Fund Drive. That effort continues in earnest statewide from Monday, March 6 through Friday, March 17. All Community Services Offices, Division of Child Support offices and Disability Determination offices are encouraged to adopt a tiny home by purchasing the supplies for a Welcome Basket and/or making a cash, check or payroll donation to furnish a tiny home through the Combined Fund Drive. Further, I ask staff here in ESA headquarters in Olympia to join me in supplying and furnishing a tiny home as a model for display at the Showcase of Skills on March 27th where the generosity of ESA will also be displayed in a storyboard with the total raised from this Supply Drive. When you think about it, this is a very attainable goal. If together we created a Welcome Basket and raised just \$300 from each office, we could furnish not only the 25 tiny homes built for the Showcase of Skills, but for the next two or three residents to be housed thereafter. This would ensure each person arrives to their new home with everything they need to make the transition from homelessness to housed as seamless as possible. Theresa Slusher, Housing Stability Manager here at ESA adds: "with an expensive and tight housing market, all housing and shelter types are needed to create pathways to stable housing. The Showcase of Skills build is a bold project creating tiny homes to be used to provide basic shelter and safety as well as connecting people to services and permanent housing. I'm proud to work for a state administration that is just as bold in offering to provide the furnishings and supplies to welcome new residents in from the elements and providing them a pathway to stability". By volunteering, donating and supporting efforts like this supply drive, you are responding to the crisis and making an enormous difference. Thank you! For more information about the drive, please contact Theresa Slusher at (360) 725-4907.		
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ESA News template (redesign)

Economic Services Administration		Britton, Chris   
Title	OPINION: Verdict Is In: Food Stamps Put Poor Kids on Path to Success	
Body	Congress is expected to vote this week on a new farm bill, which includes changes to the food stamp program. Lawmakers should take the time to read up on recent research about the program's effects. Innovative research has demonstrated convincingly that young children whose families receive food stamps benefit later in life.   OPINION: Verdict Is In: Food Stamps Put Poor Kids on Path to Success Long-term evidence starting in the 1960s now shows that government support in childhood reduces the need for welfare in adulthood. By Peter R. Orszag Dec. 4, 2018 Congress is expected to vote this week on a new farm bill, which includes changes to the food stamp program. Lawmakers should take the time to read up on recent research about the program's effects. Innovative research has demonstrated convincingly that young children whose families receive food stamps benefit later in life. Food stamps, technically known as the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program, is the nation's most important anti-hunger program. Last year, more than 40 million low-income working families, people with disabilities and poor seniors received assistance, averaging about \$125 a month. Roughly 70 percent of the participants live in families with children. The classic problem in teasing out the impact of something like food assistance to poor working families with children is the old adage about correlation versus causation. Because we don't randomly assign families to the program, it can be hard to tell what impact the program itself had. But the researchers – led in particular by Hilary Hoynes of the University of California at Berkeley and Diane Whitmore Schanzenbach of Northwestern University – have a clever way of getting around that problem. The food stamp program was established on a pilot basis in eight poor counties by President John F. Kennedy in 1961; the pilot was expanded to more than 40 counties in the early 1960s. The Food Stamp Act of 1964 then authorized the creation of a program in every county in the nation, at the county's option. More and more counties adopted the program, and legislation in 1973 then mandated that every county participate by 1975. So between 1962 and 1975, the program became available in an increasing number of counties. Read the entire article here. The birth of SNAP  In fulfillment of a campaign promise made in West Virginia, President Kennedy's first Executive Order called for expanded food distribution and, on February 2, 1961, he announced the initiation of Food Stamp pilot programs. By January 1964, the pilot programs had expanded from eight areas to 43 (40 counties, Detroit, St. Louis, and Pittsburgh) in 22 States with 380,000 participants. Learn more about the origins of the Food Stamp Program.	
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